

AI Vendor Decision Memo and Approval Record

Use this document to record the final decision after a lite checklist or full AI vendor assessment. Keep the completed memo in your AI vendor file and update your AI use inventory.

1. Review summary

Vendor: _____

Product / feature: _____

Business owner: _____

Requesting team: _____

Reviewer: _____

Date reviewed: _____

Review type: ☐ Lite checklist ☐ Full vendor assessment ☐ Renewal review ☐ Change review

Decision: ☐ Approved ☐ Approved with conditions ☐ Rejected ☐ More information needed

Risk tier: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High ☐ Unacceptable

2. Proposed use

Briefly describe the approved or requested use case.

Users / teams allowed to use it:

Approved data categories:

Prohibited data categories:

Output destination:

- ☐ Internal only
- ☐ Customer/client/student/patient/applicant/employee-facing with review
- ☐ Public-facing with review
- ☐ Decision support with additional review
- ☐ Not approved for output use

3. Evidence reviewed

Check materials reviewed.

- ☐ Vendor privacy policy
- ☐ Vendor terms of service
- ☐ Data processing agreement
- ☐ Security report or trust center
- ☐ Subprocessor list
- ☐ Data retention and deletion terms
- ☐ Training/product-improvement data-use terms
- ☐ AI safety, evaluation, red-team, or bias materials
- ☐ Contract order form or master agreement
- ☐ Internal use-case notes
- ☐ IT/security review
- ☐ Privacy/legal review
- ☐ HR/procurement/leadership review
- ☐ Other: _____

Links or file locations:

4. Key findings

Data handling summary:

Security summary:

AI-specific risk summary:

Contract/legal review summary:

Open issues:

5. Conditions if approved

Use these as prompts. Delete or edit what does not apply.

- ☐ Use limited to the approved use case above.
- ☐ Use limited to approved users/teams above.
- ☐ No customer, employee, student, health, financial, legal, confidential, regulated, or NDA data.
- ☐ Human review required before external or decision-related use.
- ☐ No use for decisions about people.

- ☐ SSO/MFA/admin controls must be configured before rollout.
 - ☐ DPA/BAA/transfer terms must be signed before use.
 - ☐ Training/product-improvement opt-out must be confirmed before first use.
 - ☐ Vendor must provide missing documentation before broader rollout.
 - ☐ Pilot only; re-review before expansion.
 - ☐ Re-review after material vendor, model, feature, data, workflow, or contract change.
 - ☐ Other conditions:
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6. Rejection rationale, if rejected

Primary reason:

- ☐ Data use not acceptable
- ☐ Security posture not acceptable
- ☐ Contract terms not acceptable
- ☐ Use case too high risk
- ☐ Vendor information incomplete
- ☐ Duplicative of approved tool
- ☐ Budget or procurement issue
- ☐ Other: _____

Explanation:

Can this be reconsidered later?

- ☐ No
- ☐ Yes, if vendor changes posture
- ☐ Yes, if proposed use is narrowed
- ☐ Yes, after qualified review

7. Approvals

Business owner approval:

Name: _____ Date: _____

Privacy/legal reviewer, if applicable:

Name: _____ Date: _____

Security/IT reviewer, if applicable:

Name: _____ Date: _____

Procurement/finance reviewer, if applicable:

Name: _____ Date: _____

Final approver:

Name: _____ Date: _____

8. Follow-up actions

Action	Owner	Due date	Status
Add to AI use inventory			
Add to approved tools list			
Configure admin controls			
Notify users of approved scope			
Confirm data-use settings			
Calendar next review			
Save evidence file			

9. Next review

Next review date: _____

Review trigger:

- ☐ Annual review
- ☐ Six-month review
- ☐ Pilot end
- ☐ Contract renewal
- ☐ Vendor model or feature change
- ☐ Data category change
- ☐ Workflow expansion
- ☐ Incident or complaint
- ☐ Other: _____

Disclaimer

This document is a template for educational and informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Consult qualified counsel and appropriate privacy, security, procurement, HR, and technical reviewers before relying on this memo for legal compliance, regulated use cases, sensitive data use, or vendor approval decisions.